

Survey Design Seminar

SurvMeth 670

Winter 2026

Week 1: Course introduction. Types of consulting and understanding client problems & needs.

January 8, 2026

Outline of Today's Class

- Introductions
- Course overview and syllabus review
- Next steps

- Introduction to consulting
 - Types of consulting and problem-solving arrangements
- Understanding client problems & needs
- Forming client relationships
- Managing client meetings

Introductions

- Instructors
 - Instructors: Michael Elliott & Michael Traugott
- Clients
 - Design Surveys in Two African Countries: Justine M. Davis and Fiona Shen-Bayh, Michigan and Maryland
 - Analyzing Experimental Results, Designing New Ones - American Speech-Language-Hearing Association
 - Design a Survey Recruitment Protocol for a New HRS Sample – Brady West and Andrew Hupp
 - Design a “Crisis” Module for the PSID – Tom Crossley
 - Analyze Survey for the Ann Arbor Rotary Club with Goal of Membership Retention - Rona Hu
 - Design Comparative Surveys on Personal Finances – Survey Monkey

Student Introductions

- JPSM Students
- MPSM Students

Name, program track, internship, desired employment

Course Overview

- Class structure
 - Lectures Thursdays 9:30 A.M. -- 12:00 P.M.
 - Working in groups and alone at the end
 - Presentations
 - Client presentations January 22 (9:00 A.M. – 12:00 P.M.)
 - Team preliminary presentations February 12
 - Team final presentations April 2
 - Team meetings
 - Assignments & tasks
 - Team assignments
 - Team tasks
 - Individual tasks: Project preferences, team evaluations
 - Individual assignment: Final project

Course Overview

The applied skills we will work on:

- * Collaboration and teamwork
- * Working with clients to achieve their goals
- * Communication with clients
- * Being a constructive, helpful critic
- * Providing useful information and products

Half of your evaluation will be based on your team's effort, and half will be based on your final individual assignment

Time Management

- Read syllabus carefully, and check class Canvas site frequently
- Course website:
<https://umich.instructure.com/courses/830921>
- Canvas resources for students:
<https://community.instructure.com/en/kb/canvas-lms-student-guide>
- Schedule your time

Course Tasks & Assignments

The full schedule of class assignments and tasks is listed in the Course Summary section following the Syllabus:

<https://umich.instructure.com/courses/830921/assignments/syllabus>

This is subject to change depending on the flow of the class, so check this link on the Canvas site periodically.

Tasks and Assignments

- Submit tasks and assignments through the Canvas site (format: MS Word document, PowerPoint presentation where applicable)
- Seven group and one individual assignment (often due Mondays, 5 pm). Each team member will receive the same grade for each assignment
- Homework submissions will be graded on four-levels: check-plus (100), check (90), check-minus (80), and not submitted (0)
- If homework is submitted late without prior permission, scores will be check-plus (70), check (60), and check-minus (50)
- Grading:

Description	%
Seven assignments	20
Preliminary presentation	10
Final presentation	20
RFP Proposal	50
Total	100

- Peer (teammate) evaluations - based on the significance of each individual's contributions
- will be used to adjust the Team grade contribution to the individual grade.

Peer Evaluations

- Give us a better understanding of the amount of work individual members have contributed to the Team assignments and to guarantee **fair grading**
- Each Team member will rate the effort put into the preparation of assignments of each of the other Team members
 - **Overall, this team member made a satisfactory contribution to the Team's project ...**
 - **This team member participated fully in the design of the project ...**
 - **This team member contributed sufficiently to the presentations to the client...**
- Form is saved in Canvas site

Today's Next Steps

- Complete Task 1 (preliminary preferences)
- After the client presentations, we will form the Teams (spreadsheet and, if necessary, random selection & assignment of some individuals to a Team)
- Review and note the class schedule
- Prepare for the client meeting
 - In preparation for your client meetings in two weeks: background research (Google) on the business and the individuals with whom you will be meeting.
 - Size of the business, organization, dollar volume, background & interests of the people with whom Team will be consulting.
 - Review client-provided materials

Outlook for Upcoming Weeks

- For Week 2:
 - Communicate with class members to discuss preferences
- For Week 3:
 - Prepare for client meeting – 30 minutes for client presentation and your questions. With six clients, we will have an extended seminar

Team Preference & Assignment

- Preference forms uploaded to Canvas site under Task 1
- Check Team size to determine need for moving students to different teams
- Move students from “over-populated” to “under-populated” teams